

HASHKAMA WEEKLY

פרשת ויקהל-פקודי
כד' אדר תשפ"ו
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חכמה ב-א' תאמין?

By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Parshas Vayakhel opens with a counterintuitive building strategy: a strict command to halt production entirely. "Sheshes yamim tei'aseh melachah..." "Six days work may be done, but on the seventh day you shall have sanctity" (Shemos 35:2). Before launching the massive construction of the Mishkan (Tabernacle), Moshe Rabbeinu issues a severe reminder about Shabbos. Rashi (Shemos 35:2) notes this juxtaposition teaches that even building the Mishkan does not override Shabbos. If our shul's boiler broke mid-January, the building committee would undoubtedly debate the halachic loopholes for emergency overtime. Yet, Hashem insists the holiest architectural project in human history must take a back seat to resting. The Kli Yakar explains this prevents overzealous individuals from assuming that laboring for God's physical house justifies violating His holy day. Soon after, we encounter an entirely different, yet equally miraculous halt to production: a fundraiser that was actually too successful. The Bnei Yisroel (Children of Israel) brought so much material that Moshe issued a proclamation: "Al ya'asu od melachah..." "Let no man or woman do any more work for the offering of the Sanctuary" (Shemos 36:6). Have you ever witnessed a shul president desperately banging on the bimah (podium) shouting, "Please, stop writing checks! We have too much money!"? It practically defies the laws of Jewish physics. The Sefas Emes (Vayakhel) masterfully connects these two events. Shabbos is the discipline of stopping our mundane labor, recognizing Hashem is the true Creator. Moshe's command to cease donating uses the exact same spiritual muscle: the profound discipline to recognize when even a holy endeavor has reached its limit. Both demand the humility to declare, "I have done my part; the rest is up to the Ribono Shel Olam (Master of the Universe)." **Practical Takeaway:** We constantly exhaust ourselves on the endless treadmill of hishtadlus (human effort), whether we are trying to close a stubborn business deal, navigate the shidduch (matchmaking) crisis, or finally decipher why the ezras nashim (women's section) thermostat is permanently set to "Arctic." Vayakhel teaches us that the ultimate test of faith is knowing when to hit the brakes. This week, practice the holy art of stopping. When Friday afternoon arrives, or when you have honestly done everything physically possible for a difficult situation, put down your proverbial hammer. Rest assured that the Aibeshter (The Almighty) is perfectly capable of running the universe while you take a well-deserved Shabbos nap.

News & Simchos!

Attention Gentlemen

Friday Mincha: 2:30 PM

Please be advised that our Friday Mincha has officially migrated from 1:30 PM to a decidedly more leisurely 2:30 PM. This deliberate schedule adjustment affords you exactly one additional hour to frantically avoid helping with Shabbos preparations. We formally request your prompt attendance next Friday at the new time. Be assured, the Gabbai's disapproving glare has already been meticulously recalibrated for 2:30.

Exciting Opportunity!

If you'd like to light up our lives with a sponsorship or add some flavor with a kiddush sponsorship, please

contact Tzvi Zev Rubin:

845-252-1260



Drasha Duty!

To give the Short Shiur after davening, please contact Rabbi Genack:

646-413-5551



Sponsorship

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Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

5:47/6:43 pm (Early/Late) הדלקה

--: pm מנחה - קבלת שבת

7:01 pm שקיעה

5:48/5:57 am (16.1/72) עלות השחר

7:09:23 am נץ החמה

7:15 am שחרית

Hot kiddush & Shiur after davening

9:32/10:08 am ס"ז קריאת שמע

10:42/11:06 am ס"ז תפילה

1:05:24 pm חצות היום

1:35:24 pm מנחה גדולה (30)

4:33:24 pm מנחה קטנה (גר"א)

5:47:37 pm פלג המנחה (גר"א)

--: pm מנחה

7:02 pm שקיעה

7:43/7:52 pm (8.5/50) צה"כ ר' משה

7:54 pm מעריב (52)

8:02/8:14 pm (60/72) צה"כ



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm מנחה

6:50 pm הדלקה

7:08 pm שקיעה

7:15 am שחרית

7:09 pm שקיעה

8:01 pm מעריב (52)

This Week's Riddle

Riddle: Which two of the 12 stones found on the choshen are mentioned elsewhere in the Torah - not in relation to the Mishkan?

(Bereishis 2:12) (Describing the rivers flowing from the Gan Eden epoch (35:9) also appears in Parshas Bereishis when on both the choshen (39:13) and the straps of the Sina (Shemos 24:10). (2) The shoham stone which is Mishpatim as the vision the Zekenim saw at Mount (Shemos 39:11) and also mentioned in Parshas Answer: (1) The sapir stone is on the choshen



Donations & Payments

Zelle: Send to 845-252-1260

Check: Write Out to Bais Midrash 715

Cash: Hand to Tzvi Zev or Adam Edelstein

Credit Card: Ask Tzvi Zev Rubin for a link

Gift Card/Bitcoin: Do we look like Indian Scammers to you?

משל ונמשל ב-א תאמין?

By Reb Gemini

Mashal: Imagine the annual budget meeting of our very own shul. The *Gabbai*—who frankly has not cracked a smile since 1998—is sweating profusely over the master spreadsheet. Every last dollar must be accounted for because the congregation demands to know exactly where their hard-earned funds went. Did the money go toward the stunning new *Aron Kodesh* (Holy Ark), or did it mysteriously vanish into funding an unusually lavish weekly spread of *yapchik* (potato and meat pudding) and premium jalapeño herring for the *hashkamah minyan* (early prayer quorum)? A meticulous auditor is brought in to review the books. He does not just want the big numbers; he wants the receipts for the plastic tablecloths and the leftover cholent bowls. If the auditor misses a single penny, the entire congregation begins to whisper that someone is secretly building a summer home in the Catskills on their dime. The rigorous demand for transparency isn't just about the money; it is about establishing absolute, unshakable trust. After all, without absolute trust, nobody is ever donating to the annual *Kiddush* fund again. **Nimshal:** This relates directly to Parshas Pekudei. “*Eileh pekudei HaMishkan...*” “These are the reckonings of the Tabernacle” (Shemos 38:21). Moshe Rabbeinu, the ultimate *Gadol HaDor* (leader of the generation), the man who spoke to Hashem *panim el panim* (face to face), insists on an exhaustive public audit. The Midrash Tanchuma (Pekudei 7) explains that Moshe heard the *leitzanim* (scoffers) of *Klal Yisroel* (the Jewish people) whispering behind his back, jokingly speculating that with all the communal gold being collected, Moshe must be getting incredibly wealthy. Moshe, rather than delivering a fiery *shmuess* (ethical discourse) about the severe prohibitions of *lashon hara* (derogatory speech), simply brings out the ledger. He gives an exact accounting of the gold, silver, and copper down to the absolute last *beka* (half-shekel). If the greatest prophet in Jewish history understood that he needed to fulfill the mandate of “*vehiyitem nekiyim me'Hashem u'miYisroel*”—to be clean before God and before Israel (Bamidbar 32:22)—how much more so must we, who occasionally struggle to remember where we parked our minivans, ensure our actions are entirely above suspicion? The ultimate standard of a *Yid* (Jew) isn't merely avoiding sin; it is avoiding even the optical illusion of sin. **Practical Takeaway:** The lesson for our daily *avodah* (spiritual service) is glaringly clear, and it applies far beyond the shul's notoriously strict accounting books. We must conduct our personal and professional lives with such transparent integrity that even the most cynical observer could not invent a scandal if they tried. This week, make a conscious *cheshbon hanefesh* (spiritual accounting) of your daily interactions. Ensure your business dealings are strictly *al pi halachah* (according to Jewish law), your *maaser* (tithing) is calculated with the precision of a *Rosh Yeshivah* (dean) analyzing a complex *Rashba* (medieval Talmudic commentary), and your interpersonal conduct leaves absolutely no room for raised eyebrows. Transparency is the ultimate *kiddush Hashem* (sanctification of God's name), and frankly, keeping your spiritual receipts in perfect order is infinitely less painful than dealing with a heavenly audit 120 years down the line.

GOOD SHABBUS!